Global CO_2 Emissions

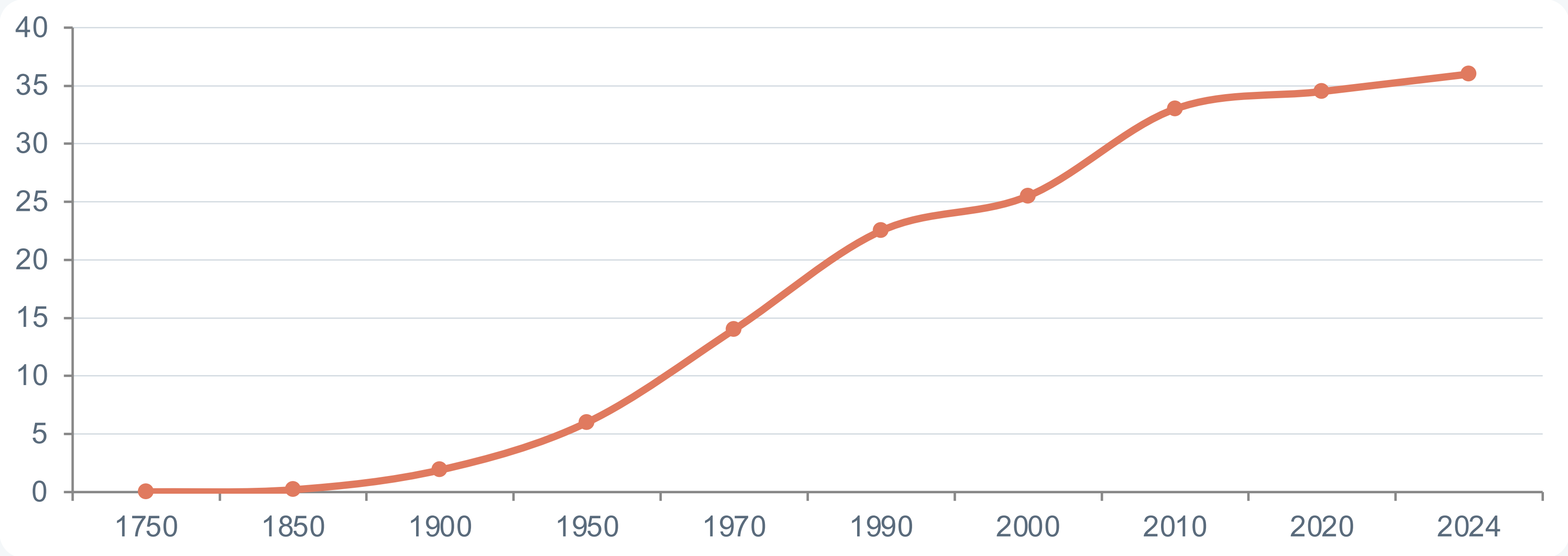
Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry · 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

For policy analysts, climate negotiators & sustainability researchers

Global CO_2 Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



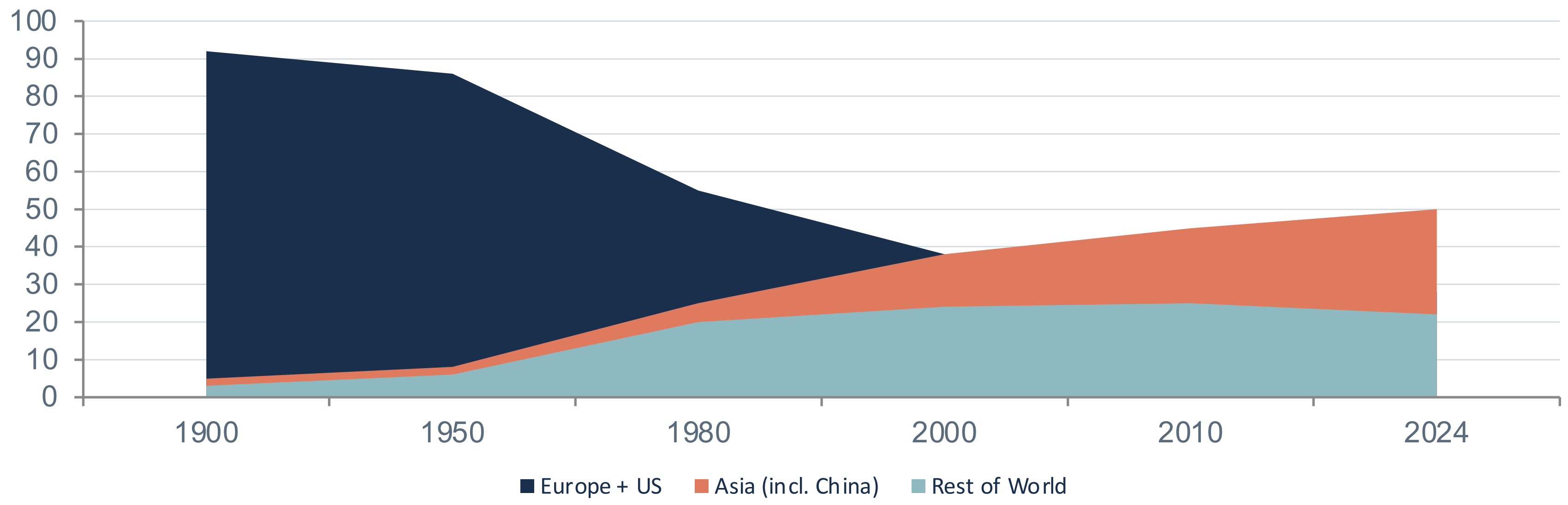
Pre-industrial: negligible

Post-1950: rapid acceleration

Today: >35 Bt, no peak yet

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

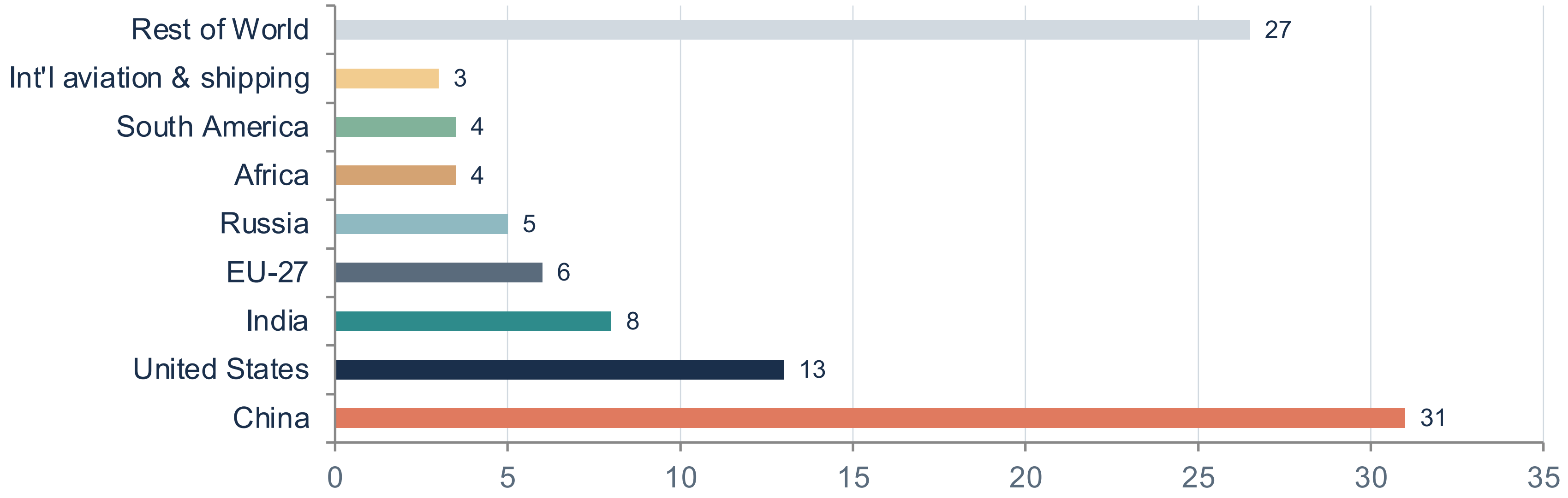
Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



In 1900, Europe + US >90%. Today Asia alone ≈50%.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO_2



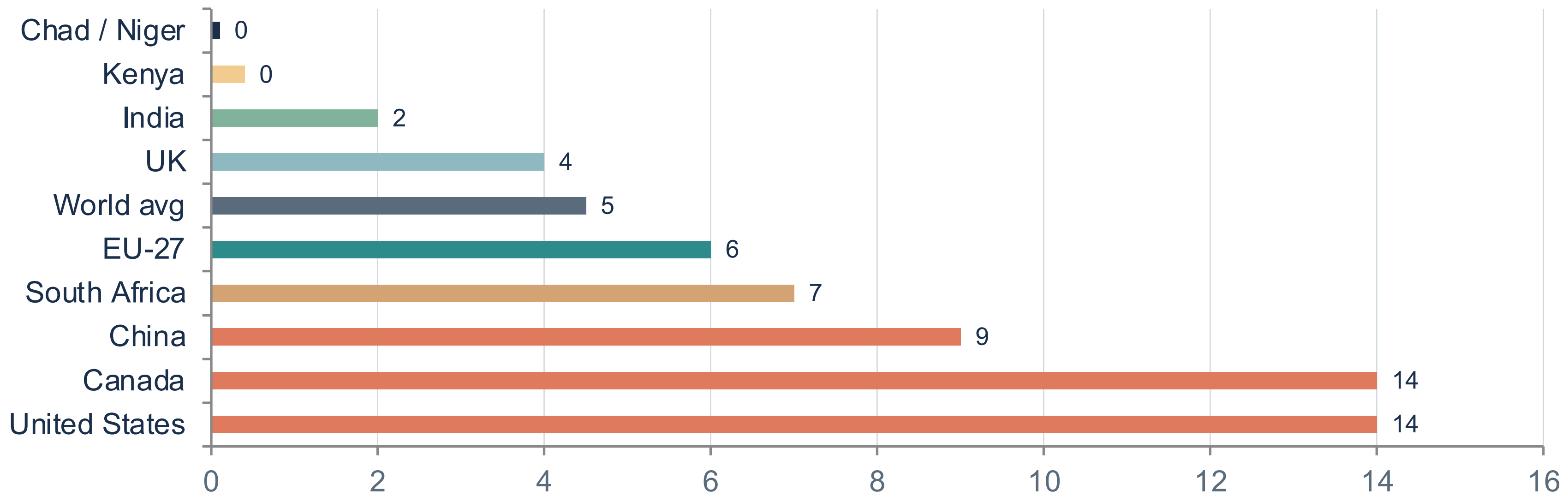
China ~31% (rising, slowing)

US ~13% (declining)

India ~8% (rising)

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

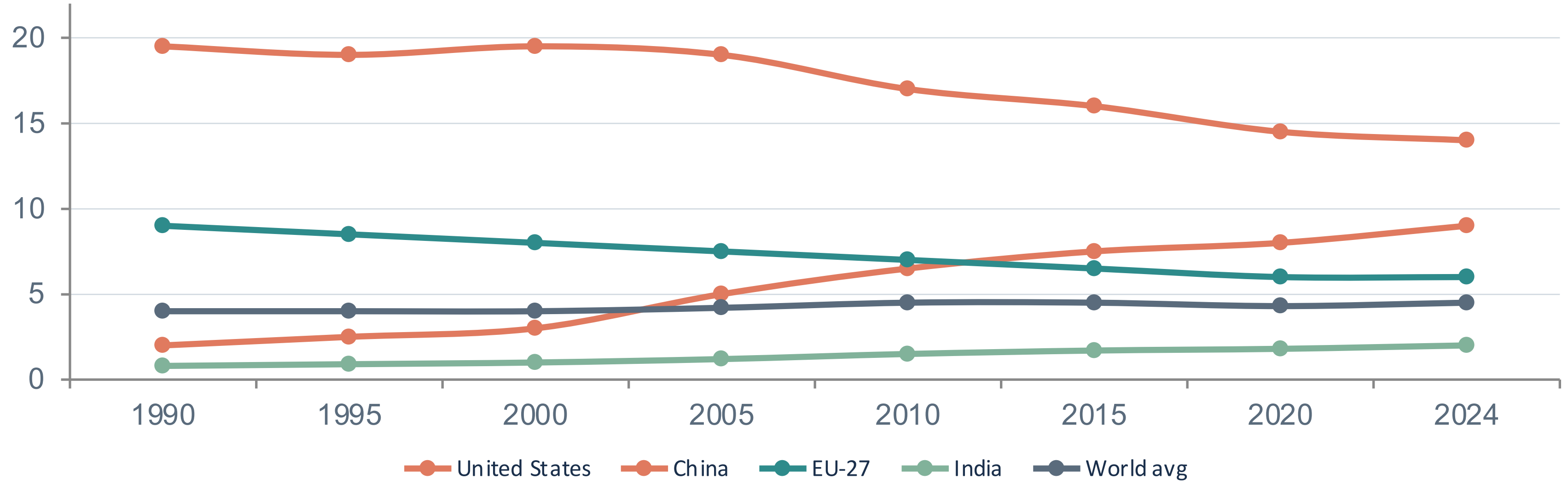
Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



150× gap: an American emits in ~2 days what a person in Niger emits in a year

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

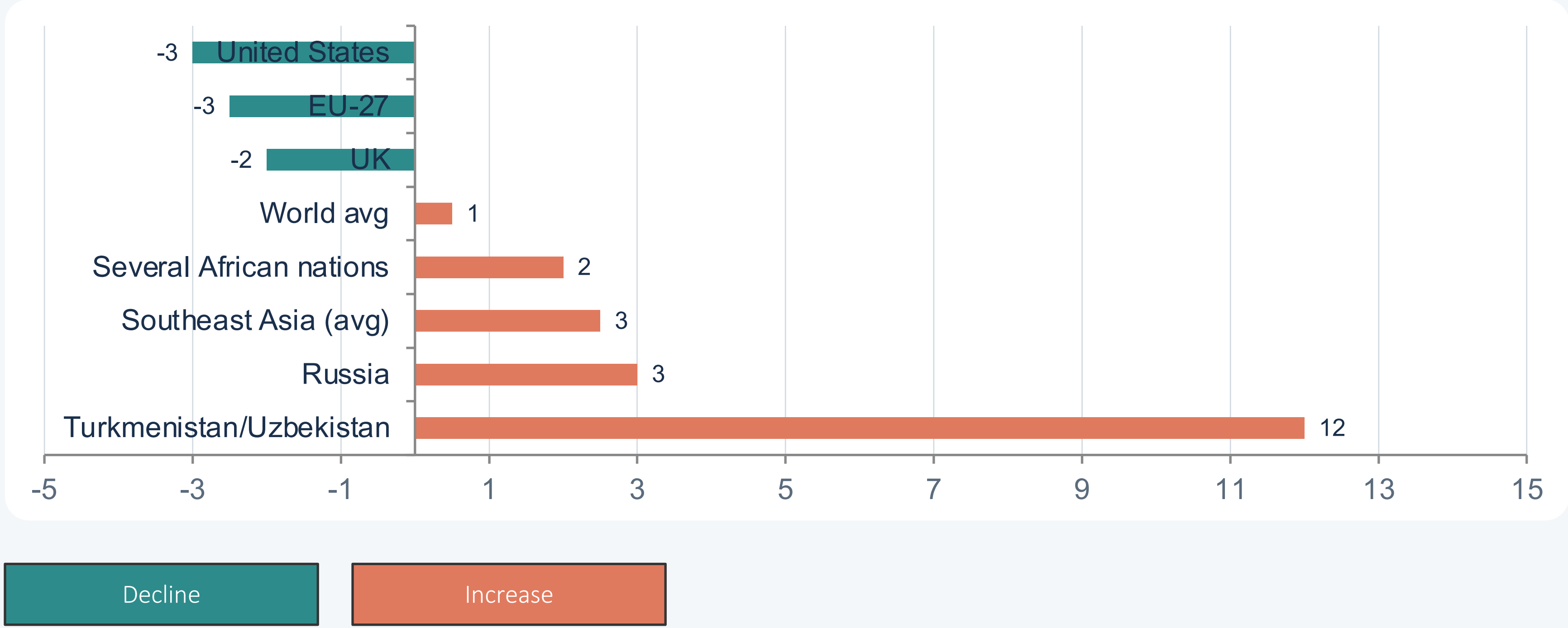
Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



China's per capita remains below the US despite being the largest total emitter

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US

Higher fossil share
US, Germany, Netherlands rely more on coal, oil, and gas for electricity and transport.

More nuclear & renewables
France, UK, and Portugal generate a higher share of electricity from nuclear and renewables.

Policy implication
Similar prosperity levels can yield very different emissions depending on energy mix choices.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

01

No peak yet
Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and haven't peaked, despite slowing growth.

02

China is largest annual emitter
But per capita emissions remain below the US.

03

Historical responsibility
Europe and the US dominated emissions historically (>90% in 1900) but now account for <⅓.

04

Massive per capita inequality
A 150× gap persists between the lowest emitters (~0.1 t) and highest large-country emitters (~14 t).

05

Energy policy matters
Countries with similar prosperity can have very different emissions depending on energy mix and technology choices.

Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data